Questions to Ask Dad's Doctor, His Therapist and His Pharmacist About Which Changes Are Worth a Call

Fourteen questions, sorted by who can answer them, with room to write what they say.

Dad's next checkup is a routine one, which suits these questions. Bring them written down, ask them as they are, and write the answer under each.

This guide doesn't answer the questions and doesn't say which matters most. Which changes are worth a call depends on Dad, and the people below are the ones who know his health.

Dad's doctor

1. Here is the help Dad gets in an ordinary week. Is there anything on this page you'd like to know more about?

2. Which changes would you want to hear about from us, and who in your office should we tell?

3. Is there any kind of help you consider necessary for him now? If so, could it be noted in writing, with the date?

4. If we ever had questions about whether Dad should have someone with him or checking in at certain times, who would assess that?

5. If something did change, who would take a fresh look at what he needs, and how does a family ask for that?

A nurse at his doctor's office

If there is one Dad sees, or one who returns the family's calls.

1. When we notice something different, what is useful for us to write down?

2. Is there anything about Dad's hearing, sight or speech that the people who help him should know?

His therapist, if he sees one

A physical or occupational therapist, for example.

1. How does Dad get around now, indoors and out, and is there anything you'd like us to note about it over time?
2. Which of the things he does now would you want to look at again later, and what would prompt that?

His pharmacist

1. Which changes in how Dad manages his medications would you want to hear about?
2. If we have a question about his medications, who do we ask before anything is changed?

Your care consultant

Someone who looks at the whole picture with Dad and the family.

1. Here is our record of today. What else would you want to know before you'd call it complete?
2. Which of our open questions need a clinician to confirm?
3. We've listed what is essential to Dad about his help and what is a preference. What would you want to understand better about either list?

What this guide doesn't do

It doesn't answer these questions, say which change matters most, or tell you what an answer means for Dad. If something about him seems urgent to you, it isn't a question for this page. Call his doctor's office, or emergency services in an emergency.

Ready for the next step?

You have your questions, and a routine visit to ask them at. The care interview asks about every area of Dad's daily life, so what his doctor, his therapist and his pharmacist tell you has a full picture to sit beside, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›
